Amphion is an EV mobility solutions arm of battery tech startup Log9, full-stack EV asset management that includes EV financing, leasing, data and analytics, charging infrastructure, energy efficiency, health checks, and more.

What inspired the 'Amphion' move?

We have been managing close to 3000 electric vehicle assets with Log9 batteries for a long time now. As the industry started to know about the same more and more, a lot of requests came our way for managing EVs in fleets. These generally include managing vehicles and other assets that are not connected with Log9 tech.

How did you decide to enter the segment?

The challenges faced by the industry are what made us decide to enter the segment. That is why we came up with a new brand, one that is separate from Log9. We have been managing assets that do not have Log9 batteries in them for three months now.

What challenges are you looking to address via Amphion?

Vehicle financing and leasing are a part of the challenge. The bigger part of the challenge for every fleet owner is the uptime of the vehicle. Missing a day or two due to an error or any other reason usually results in huge penalties for them.

Please elaborate on that.

The average servicing time for an electric two- and a three-wheeler is over 18 days in India at the moment. This is for cases which require change of a part and issues associated with the same. A commercial EV having to spend 18 days off the road would mean no profits for the entire year because of the penalties involved.

In such cases, fleet owners need to have a team dedicated to taking care of the maintenance and service parts, which is also an added cost to them. We have been able to maintain an average service TAT (turn around time) of less than 2.5 days.

Are there more challenges apart from the maintenance and service?

Yes, the availability of the proper EV charging ecosystem is a challenge. Then, for fleet owners looking to venture into geographies, finding finance organisations as well as the right dealers is a big challenge! This is followed by the added burden of getting the vehicles registered and insured. These are all added costs for a fleet owner. Even selling the vehicle in the used market and predicting good health for the battery is a challenge!

Claiming asset management capabilities and not being able to deliver uptime leads to lot of issues between fleets and leasing companies, which results in defaults on lease payments, penalties being adjusted into lease payments, and eventually large NPAs in the ecosystem, which keeps on increasing the risk and hence the cost of capital, further making the entire ecosystem too costly and unsustainable.

Are all the services being offered by Amphion? What are the benefits?

Apart from these, there are some other services under the Amphion brand, but those largely remain under this big umbrella. The biggest benefit for fleet owners is the saved cost per month, which is in the range of ₹7000 to ₹8000 per vehicle. It can also be measured in the extra time they can give to adding more business. This is the time they are saving by not concentrating their efforts on the challenges we have discussed.

But what reduces their costs?

We have direct leverage with the vehicle makers. Then, we can predict a battery's health using the tech that we have built. It throws over 30 crucial data points every second. The tech can also be used to suggest better driving behaviours in order to increase the mileage of a vehicle.

You mentioned the collection of data. Do you equip these vehicles with some device?

Data is collected from all the vehicles we manage. In the case of assets with a Log9 battery, these batteries send data. We also work with partners such as Bosch and Zero Carbon. We do not work with any products that do not throw any data.

But aren't there a lot of players in this arena?

There is a big difference between saying someone does it and saying someone actually does it! Technological capability is one of the prime requirements for managing a fleet of EVs. Then, there must be a dedicated operational layer across the country and a team only looking into analysing data. A lot of companies claim to do it because it helps them charge a higher lease of finance amount for the same. But what they do when customers reach out to them for penalties is tell them it was an error on the customer's part! A lot of companies do it to only increase their internal rate of return (IRR). (Note: IRR is used as a metric to estimate the profitability of potential investments.)